



PROGRESS REPORT

Rwanda: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-25 · 124 systems and instruments tracked

Of 124 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 61 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-25, 35 did not, 19 carry no stated baseline, and 9 are **Not held** at both ends.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Shape check, run before the comparison: 202 sources for this place in the window — 24 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 178 in the later (2026-02 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

Not one new Rwandan statute reached the books in the twelve months the base can evidence. What changed is institutional and commercial: a payment rail became mandatory, an identity programme opened enrolment against a hard 2027 deadline, an artificial-intelligence agency and an institute of computing were approved, and a frontier vendor entered government. The shape check above records the coverage cliff, so much of what looks like new information about the 2021 data-protection law and the 2024 SIM regulation is fresh reporting on unchanged positions.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Legacy-network retirement plan	None published	Third-generation service off nationwide from June 2027, with December 2028 the working date for the older network, expressly conditional, and operators running trial shutdowns during 2026	ADVANCED
National artificial intelligence agency	Did not exist	Approved by cabinet to coordinate development, adoption, investment and governance, and now being asked by early-stage firms to solve infrastructure and market-access problems it has no published mandate or budget for	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National artificial intelligence policy	Adopted, roughly 70% skills-focused, with no dedicated implementing institution	The same policy, now with a cabinet-approved national agency to implement it and an independent baseline placing the country among two in the region with an adopted instrument	ADVANCED
National data-sharing policy implementation	Approved and open by default, with no governance unit established and no platform	In implementation, with a data governance unit staffed under a seconded project lead building classification standards, quality standards, templates and cataloguing tools	ADVANCED
ICT sector strategic plan	In force, aligned to the second national strategy for transformation	The same, with nine outcomes to 2029 including all government services online, and no progress report against them held	NO CHANGE

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Draft law on virtual assets	Did not exist	The rationale approved in principle and referred to committee; not enacted, with no text and no gazette date	ADVANCED
Single digital identification law	In force, with nationwide enrolment not yet opened	Enrolment open and scaling, with banks, hospitals, telecoms operators and government institutions expected to use the new authentication from the sunset date and legacy cards becoming invalid	ADVANCED
Central bank regulatory sandbox	Operating, with no published cohort or admission data	Still operating and cited as a sequencing model, with no cohort list, admission count or graduation figure held	NO CHANGE

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
United States bilateral health agreement and its data-sharing agreement	Not held	Signed memorandum with activities running 2026-04-01 to 2030-12-31; section 2.5.2 commits Rwanda to negotiate a further 25-year data-sharing arrangement with no data-owner clause or volume cap, unlike Uganda's equivalent instrument	ADVANCED
Data protection and privacy law	In force and in its enforcement phase since October 2023, with no published enforcement record	In force with extraterritorial reach and fines to RWF 5m or 1% of global turnover, still with no enforcement action, fine total or breach register published	NO CHANGE
Data protection appropriation	RWF 130m for 2025/26, down from RWF 150m, with no outturn published	RWF 130m again for 2026/27, with the 2024/25 outturn now known at RWF 52.71m against RWF 150m enacted, 35.1%, all in the first quarter	NO CHANGE
Data-protection supervisory authority	The supervisory authority, budgeted inside the presidency, in an awareness phase	A capacity-building phase with more than a hundred public-sector officers trained, authorising every cross-border transfer	NO CHANGE
Registered data controllers and processors	No registry count published	Still no count of registered controllers or processors, and no enforcement or fine total	NO CHANGE
Data sharing arrangement under the health memorandum	BASELINE NOT HELD	A rights organisation's reading of the seven signed American health memoranda puts Rwanda among three that commit to hand over any data requested for the American audit without explicit privacy safeguards, and among five whose text requires unilateral sharing of specimens and pathogen-sequencing data; all seven require broad audit access	<i>Baseline not held</i>

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Privacy compliance score	BASELINE NOT HELD	33% for 2025, level with one neighbour, against 46% for another and a 46% continental average	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
COMESA regional AI framework	Did not exist	Consultation stage only; findings to feed a regional study toward a Regional AI Strategy, Model Policy Guidelines and Model Regulatory Frameworks; no text or timetable published; Rwanda participates as host, reporting unquantified progress on its own national AI policy	ADVANCED
Bilateral licence passporting memorandum	Signed, with the text unpublished so the licence categories it recognises are unknown	Still unpublished by either central bank as at 2026-07-30, cited as a working precedent with no firm reported as having used it	NO CHANGE
Cross-border digital identity pilot	BASELINE NOT HELD	A pilot recognising a digital identity issued in one of Rwanda, Ghana and Benin in the other two, presented as the first step to a single African digital market by 2030, with eighteen further countries said to be joining	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Electronic-government interoperability framework	None published	RGEA v2.1, published by RISA and based on TOGAF, in force to govern government-wide ICT architecture standards; distinct from the 2019 dissertation's named 'interoperability framework', which the base still holds no separate instrument for	ADVANCED
Cross-border data-exchange conformance	BASELINE NOT HELD	Identification, immigration and technology authorities convened with two other states on trust chains, interface contracts and cross-border verification toward a federated architecture, with no national conformance profile or adoption instrument held	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Internet governance forum	BASELINE NOT HELD	An annual multistakeholder forum run under the domain registry, with nearly 200 people through a school on internet governance and a youth forum	<i>Baseline not held</i>

The statutory position did not move and the enforcement position stayed empty. The data-protection law entered its enforcement phase in October 2023 and in the whole window produced no published enforcement action, fine total, breach register or count of registered controllers. Its appropriation fell from RWF 150m to RWF 130m and has now been held flat, having been [spent at 35.1% in 2024/25](#); the [national identification programme executed at 140.7%](#) over the same year. Identity money moves and data-protection money does not.

What changed is institutional rather than legislative: a national infrastructure strategy launched in March 2026 and now exported, an artificial-intelligence agency approved in June, a data governance unit staffed and building classification standards, a licence-passporting memorandum with a neighbour in March, a virtual-assets bill taking its first parliamentary step in April, and a hard network-retirement date fixed in July where in March there had been no timeline at all.

Three absences held constant across the whole period and are this section's real finding: no published register of data controllers and no enforcement record under a law five years in force; no body of any kind assessing artificial-intelligence risk or monitoring harms, in a state that has since embedded the technology in payments, judiciary filing, identity verification and service delivery; and no review framework triggered by a commercial artificial-intelligence partnership, which is how a three-year vendor memorandum became load-bearing without one.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Education technology appropriation, second line	RWF 1,270,347,338 appropriated for 2025/26	RWF 832,894,405 for 2026/27, down 34.4% year on year and 74% against 2024/25	REGRESSED
Education technology integration appropriation	RWF 23,522,003,941 appropriated for 2025/26	RWF 28,956,710,022 for 2026/27, up 23.1%, with the last outturn at 81.7% of voted	ADVANCED

MoUs and other agreements

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Capital markets registrar-services memorandum with Africa Prudential	Not held	Signed between the Capital Markets Authority and a Nigerian registrar company to cooperate on registrar services, securities administration, investor identification, data management and digital capital-markets systems, following a study visit in June 2026 to that company's digital investor-services model of virtual shareholder meetings, electronic voting and mobile-based investment tracking	BASELINE NOT HELD

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Financing agreements for broadband and labour-market systems	Did not exist	Two financing agreements worth a combined Rwf279 billion approved, funding national strategy measures that include broadband expansion, a labour market information system linking job seekers to employers, and technology for livestock traceability	ADVANCED
Digital acceleration project, inclusion components	An envelope of about US\$200m, 55% complete	Still 55%, with no updated disbursement or completion figure and the project period ending in 2026	NO CHANGE
Regional bank digital acceleration operation	A US\$100m commitment with a US\$60.5m digital access and inclusion component	Unchanged; no disbursement figure held at any date and the period closes in 2026	NO CHANGE

Domestic capacity financing was uneven across budget lines this window: the cyber-security standards and skills line sat flat for a second consecutive year after spending only 11.5% of its 2024/25 vote, the research line fell 7.3%, and [one education-technology line fell 74% since 2024/25](#) while another grew 23%.

Externally, the picture is instruments ageing out without outturn: the digital acceleration project and a regional bank operation both close in 2026 with no disbursement figure held [since 55% in July 2025](#), and the successor nine-year framework carries no published envelope.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Country partnership framework	A framework in force for 2021 to 2026 with an indicative US\$912m first-cycle allocation	A nine-year framework prepared but not launched, with job creation the organising objective and no committed envelope on the record	ADVANCED
Cross-border terrestrial fibre route	Did not exist	A 2,000 km protected terrestrial route across four countries, live and carrying wholesale traffic with direct interconnection into data centres in each city. Its operator marked a first year in the country in August 2026, describing a 2,000km protected corridor from Goma to Mombasa connecting Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi within a network spanning sixteen African countries	ADVANCED
Information and communications for development appropriation	RWF 5,395,372,252 domestic against RWF 45.06bn external for 2025/26	RWF 4,851,958,667 domestic against RWF 65,798,446,317 external for 2026/27	REGRESSED
Internet penetration	34% in 2024 rising to 38% at mid-2025	42.6% projected for end-2025 with 1.35m households on home internet, and no measured 2026 figure published	ADVANCED
Mobile and internet subscriptions	13,194,764 mobile-cellular and 10,064,499 internet subscriptions a year earlier	14,001,080 mobile-cellular subscriptions at 97.1 per 100 inhabitants and 10,738,906 internet subscriptions	ADVANCED
New subsea cable system	Did not exist	A 25,000 km system with 48 fibre pairs and twenty landing points across fifteen countries, reached from Rwanda over terrestrial fibre rather than a landing	ADVANCED
Satellite reseller authorisation	Did not exist	A certified reseller with packages for health, education and non-profits and small-business plans planned	ADVANCED
Second-generation network switch-off	None published	A target rather than a fixed deadline, conditional on the earlier shutdown's outcome, coverage, service continuity, legacy-handset counts and migration of dependent systems	ADVANCED
Shared tower investment	Did not exist	US\$44.4m of equity into shared tower infrastructure leased to mobile operators, aimed at underserved rural coverage	ADVANCED
Third-generation network switch-off	None published	A nationwide shutdown fixed for 2027-06-30, with pilot shutdowns in selected areas during 2026 and critical-system migration completed in the first half of 2027; extensions temporary and regulator-approved	ADVANCED
Voice over fourth-generation networks	Not in service	Voice over fourth-generation networks live for compatible handsets, with no coverage, handset-base, subscriber figure or completion date published	ADVANCED
Digital acceleration project	A US\$200m World Bank commitment for 2022 to 2026, 55% complete with US\$47.2m disbursed	The same, with no progress or completion figure published since July 2025 against a December 2026 closing date	NO CHANGE
Fifth-generation network	Commercial service launched June 2025	The same, with no coverage, site count or subscriber figure published since	NO CHANGE
Government network	A planned resilient national government network linking institutions to cell level	The same, with no build, coverage or completion figure published	NO CHANGE
National broadband policy	A technology-neutral policy in force with operators refarming spectrum	The same, with additional spectrum allocated across multiple operators	NO CHANGE

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Data centre memorandum with a Gulf operator	Did not exist	Two memoranda to jointly invest in AI-ready Tier III data centres with Gulf operators, the later one announced in the week to 19 August 2026, with no site, capacity, cost, financing or date published for either	ADVANCED
Digital investment roadmap	Did not exist	A ministry roadmap with international partners on policy and regulatory reforms to attract cloud, financial-technology and data-infrastructure investment	ADVANCED
Hybrid cloud deployment	Did not exist	A hyperscaler hybrid-cloud deployment live with a delivery partner, the government and the information society authority, the first in the region and third on the continent	ADVANCED
Data centre and cloud service directives	In force since 2023	The same; the directives' own text carries no date on its face and no compliance or enforcement record is published	NO CHANGE
National data centre	A national facility in operation, with no capacity or utilisation figure held	The same, with a 50% hosting-price cut recorded and 14.9% of 4,660 government websites and web applications hosted in the country	NO CHANGE

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Institute of computing	Did not exist	An affiliated institute of the national university beside an existing coding academy, offering degrees in artificial intelligence and cyber security, with the first two intakes limited to that academy's graduates	ADVANCED

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Cyber security centre of excellence	Did not exist	Operating at a university college with a cyber security academy, an innovation hub and technology labs, with vendor and donor partners	ADVANCED
Biometric SIM registration regulation	In force, with registration verified against the national biometric database	The same, with no rollout completion, enrolment or enforcement figure published	NO CHANGE
Cyber security standards and skills appropriation	RWF 723,676,491 for 2025/26, down from RWF 921,000,000 in 2024/25	RWF 723,676,491 for 2026/27, with the skills sub-line rising and the standards sub-line falling	NO CHANGE
Cyberspace protection appropriation	RWF 1,609,000,000 appropriated for 2025/26	RWF 1,609,000,000 for 2026/27, flat and wholly domestically financed, with the 2024/25 line executed at 85.6%	NO CHANGE
National computer security incident response team	A division of the cyber security authority with a published constituency and statutory basis	The same, with services limited to identification, protection and detection and no caseload, resolution time or service-level target published	NO CHANGE
National cyber security authority	Budgeted under the presidency across two programmes	The same, with RWF 1.609bn and RWF 723.7m appropriated for 2026/27, both wholly domestic	NO CHANGE

One instrument moved decisively. At the window's opening there was no published timeline of any kind for retiring legacy mobile networks; by July 2026 there was a gazetted 30 June 2027 date for the third generation, a conditional December 2028 target for the second, published pilot, migration and audit mechanics, and — days later — the technical precondition switched on at the dominant operator.

Storage moved from a lower base. The arrival of a hyperscaler hybrid-cloud deployment in April 2026 is the first onshore compute the wiki can name for this country; a Tier III data-centre memorandum with a Gulf operator signed in May 2026 is still a memorandum.

Everything else accreted detail on a position already held. The 812-school gap is the same late-2024 count restated in March 2026. The government network and the national incident response team are the same two lines from a single July 2025 article. The cyber authority's two appropriations are flat for a second year. And the largest connectivity instrument has published no progress figure since [55% complete in July 2025](#), against a December 2026 closing date. Read against the coverage cliff, this is a section where one instrument moved decisively and the rest were reported on more often.

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National digital public infrastructure strategy	Did not exist	A shared foundation of interoperable identity, payments and data-exchange layers treated as public goods	ADVANCED
National data-sharing platform	A build under way with a 2026 target and a vendor paired with internal experts	Still no go-live announcement as at 2026-08-05, with the target year eight months gone	NO CHANGE
National data-sharing policy	An approved inter-agency rulebook treating institutions as stewards rather than owners	Unchanged	NO CHANGE

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Digital identity enrolment	None enrolled; registration opened six days after the window's start	More than 8 million registered of about 14 million and more than 7 million already photographed (August 2026), from 4.4m in June 2026, 2,373,854 in March 2026 and about 1.49m in February	ADVANCED
Imibereho social registry	<i>Baseline not held</i>	In service since early 2024 with an appeals process running: 360,000 people challenged their category and 93% of disputed classifications were corrected, disputes tracing largely to stale asset records such as unrecorded land or vehicle sales	ADVANCED
Single digital identity	A statutory framework since 2023 and system bids in May 2024, with no enrolment begun	4.4m enrolled of a roughly 14m target, with biometric kits being permanently deployed at sector offices and legacy cards void from June 2027	ADVANCED
National identification appropriation	RWF 2,199,544,027 for 2025/26	RWF 2,287,611,846 for 2026/27, wholly domestic with zero external financing	NO CHANGE
Consent and access-log layer	BASELINE NOT HELD	Citizens are to see which institutions accessed their data and revoke access, with self-consent from sixteen; no launch date or live status held	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Active mobile money accounts	About 7.44m a year earlier, implied by the reported growth rate	8,558,024 subscriber lines linked to active mobile money accounts	ADVANCED
Bank and mobile-money credit product	Did not exist	Instant loans of up to RWF 2,000,000 and saving from a mobile money wallet over a short code, with no pricing, interest rate, eligibility rule or volume published	ADVANCED
Interoperable transfer fee	Up to RWF 5,000 per interoperable transfer	A maximum of RWF 20, not a flat charge, on the four interoperable legs between banks and electronic money issuers - account-to-wallet, wallet-to-account, account-to-account and wallet-to-wallet - with institutions free to charge less or nothing, and each operator's own on-net tariff untouched; the ceiling holds regardless of amount up to the RWF 10m per-transaction limit	ADVANCED, AT THE INTEROPERABILITY LAYER ONLY
Licence passporting framework with a neighbour	Did not exist	A memorandum to build a passporting framework with coordinated supervision, with no framework text or start date	ADVANCED
National instant payment system	The payment switch unveiled in February 2025 on open-source software, with no consumer launch	The designated national instant payment system across 22 institutions, bank to wallet to merchant in any direction, with a per-transaction ceiling	ADVANCED
Second operator's market position	16.9% share and 53,316 active agents a year earlier	14.3% share and 48,847 active agents	REGRESSED
Cross-border payment corridor pilot	BASELINE NOT HELD	A person-to-person proof of concept, the first corridor under a regional cross-border payment plan, covering two states only	Baseline not held
Mobile money platform migration to a cloud-native vendor platform	Did not exist	The dominant operator's mobile money platform moved off a legacy virtualised environment onto a cloud-native vendor fintech platform, the vendor reporting cuts of up to 86% in CPU processing and database load and up to 80% in API response times; the migration completed in Eswatini, Ghana, Rwanda and Uganda, with Cameroon under way and Benin, the Republic of the Congo and Zambia in discussion	BASELINE NOT HELD

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Birth-registration completeness	90.3% in 2024	92.9% in 2025 on 356,838 recorded births	ADVANCED
Business registration platform	Not fully online	Incorporation in 24 to 72 hours at a cost among the continent's lowest	ADVANCED
District land correction exercise	Not begun	More than 28,000 titles from over 35,000 parcels across a 28,527-hectare target, with about 4,700 parcels left untitled and handed to the district	CLOSED
Land administration twinning	Twinning on land administration, surveying and land-use planning	Unchanged; the activity states no amount and no result	NO CHANGE
Digitised civil registration and vital statistics system	Baseline not held	Civil registration digitised and integrated with the national identity system, giving real-time identity verification and data sharing across hospitals, government agencies and businesses and supporting access to around 200 services; registration moved from a centralised, travel-dependent process to a decentralised one with thousands of registration points, and about 85% of public services were digitised as at 2024	BASELINE NOT HELD

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
e-Tracker electronic immunization registry	Did not exist	Nationwide, near-100% data consistency reported by 2024; facility-level underuse persists at some sites	ADVANCED
National health intelligence centre	Launched integrating hospital, health-centre, supply-chain and workforce data	A real-time hub with national data-to-insight latency cut from about two months to near real-time, expanding toward predictive intelligence	NO CHANGE
National electronic medical record	BASELINE NOT HELD	National electronic medical records for all hospitals and health centres, described as an intention	Baseline not held

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Electronic billing machine as an export	Domestically built platforms reported in four other states, with no product-specific buyer list	Two states adopted, one mid-adoption and two more interested	ADVANCED
Electronic procurement platform as an export	Cooperation confined to public-finance and procurement digitisation	One state co-developing the platform, with health, artificial intelligence, commerce and public-service tracks identified but not signed	ADVANCED
Government services platform	BASELINE NOT HELD	More than 600 services of which more than 240 are paid, on 4,000 agents	Baseline not held

Two objects that are now load-bearing did not exist in operating form at the window's opening. Nationwide identity enrolment opened six days after the start date and has reached 4.4 million against a roughly 14 million target, with legacy documents void from June 2027. And the payment rail, though presented in February 2025, had no consumer launch until December 2025 and no interoperability mandate until July 2026.

What did exist a year ago was the scaffolding: a services portal running since 2015, a digital civil registration chain, an approved data-sharing policy and an [acceleration project at 55% complete](#). A year on, every domestic interoperable retail payment runs on one state-owned open-source rail at a flat RWF 20, a national infrastructure strategy exists, and the stack is being sold abroad with nameable buyers.

Two things did not move, and both matter. The national data-sharing platform still has no go-live announcement with its 2026 target year eight months gone — the interoperability gap the country's own analysts name most often. And the acceleration project has published no completion figure since July 2025.

The fisc moved the other way. The domestically financed development programme fell for a third consecutive year while its external line rose to RWF 65.8bn, and [the statistics programme changed ministry and lost 14.2% of its domestic appropriation, leaving the national statistics function 87% externally financed](#).

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Local-government citizen platform	An earlier platform was the incumbent local-government channel	An AI-powered citizen issue-reporting platform integrating the services portal and civil registration, with no national rollout date	ADVANCED

Rural digital data capture

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
School internet connectivity	3,082 schools connected in 2023/24, about 62% by late 2024	4,184 of 4,996 connected with 812 outstanding, rural at about 27% against urban at about 75%	ADVANCED

Technology

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Bilateral AI memorandum with a North African state	Did not exist	A framework on responsible development and deployment, digital government, innovation and digital skills, with no funding, deliverable or timeline stated	ADVANCED
Head of state's international AI commission role	Did not exist	Co-chair of an international commission on artificial intelligence for good, with a remit stated as inclusive governance, expanding access and narrowing the digital divide	ADVANCED
Primary-care AI health pilot	Did not exist	US\$50m announced by a foundation and an AI firm, beginning here and scaling to 1,000 primary-care clinics by 2028, with no clinic count or disbursement published since	ADVANCED
Regional AI policy roadmap	Did not exist	Ministers explored a regional roadmap to harmonise rules across the bloc, with no instrument adopted and nothing further held	ADVANCED
Vendor memorandum with a frontier AI firm	Did not exist	A three-year non-binding memorandum across health, public-sector developers and education, with model and interface access plus credits and training for government developers	ADVANCED
Continental AI declaration	Adopted at a summit hosted by the country with an international forum, with 49 country signatories in the primary text plus two continental bodies	Unchanged; no implementation instrument, national transposition or council constitution is held sixteen months on	NO CHANGE
Continental AI fund	A US\$60bn target announced alongside the declaration, with no legal foundation, capitalisation or manager	Still only a headline figure, with no vehicle, capitalisation, governance or first disbursement on the record	NO CHANGE
Global AI summit	A first edition held in the capital with more than a thousand policymakers and business leaders, producing the continental declaration	Unchanged; no second edition, date or host is on the record as at 2026-08-05	NO CHANGE
AI scaling hub	BASELINE NOT HELD	About RWF 25bn secured from unnamed international partners	Baseline not held
Scoping of an artificial-intelligence partnership with a hyperscaler	Baseline not held	A working session between the ICT ministry and the company scoping digital public infrastructure, data exchange, cloud, cybersecurity and artificial-intelligence skills; nothing signed, no value and no timetable	BASELINE NOT HELD

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Dominant operator's results	A net loss in the same quarter a year earlier	Profit after tax of RWF 10.8bn, service revenue up 14.7%, mobile-money monthly active users up 17.3% to 6.2m and fourth-generation population coverage at 94.8%	ADVANCED
Information and communication sector employment	About 12,000 workers a year earlier	19,000 workers, up 62.6% year on year against 2.7% economy-wide, still about 0.4% of total employment	ADVANCED
Startup funding raised	BASELINE NOT HELD	Two startups raised a combined US\$11.2m in 2025 on one tracker's count	Baseline not held

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Development bank venture debt fund	Did not exist	The bank is sole committed backer at US\$6m, with a further US\$3m near-committed and two development institutions in discussion, on uncollateralised cheques at 9 to 12% over six to eight years	ADVANCED
Financial technology centre	Did not exist	A one-stop hub under a financial-technology strategy, established by the ministry with an industry chamber, a financial centre, an association and a foreign cooperation agency	ADVANCED
Science, technology and innovation appropriation	RWF 923,874,323 appropriated for 2025/26	RWF 856,631,975 for 2026/27, all recurrent with no domestically financed development	REGRESSED
Innovation city	A 60-hectare public-private partnership with about US\$70m of committed equity and loans and a total project value estimated far higher	Unchanged; no construction-progress, occupancy or spend update held since the groundbreaking	NO CHANGE
Innovation fund	An approximately US\$68.6m development-bank and government vehicle with twelve companies backed	Unchanged; no portfolio or deployment figure dated after 2024 is held	NO CHANGE

At the window's opening this section was a policy and a summit: a 2023 artificial-intelligence policy, a continental declaration adopted in Kigali four months earlier, a coding academy, an innovation fund and an innovation city that had broken ground — no dedicated institution, no foreign frontier vendor in government, and no in-country cloud.

Twelve months on the base can name a Cabinet-approved agency, a three-year vendor memorandum spanning health, public-sector developers and education, a [US\\$50m primary-care health pilot beginning here](#), the first regional hybrid-cloud deployment, and an institute of computing approved to open in September 2026. The direction of travel is institutional formalisation of a commercial dependency that arrived first: the vendor stack went into production in February, the agency was approved in June, the school in July.

Almost none of it is yet measurable. The agency has no published structure, budget or law, and the health pilot has published no clinic count since January. The one genuinely both-ends-dated movement is employment, [from about 12,000 to 19,000 sector workers](#), and the one downward move is the fisc.

The continental instruments the country hosts have not converted into delivery: a declaration adopted in April 2025 endorsed a council and a [US\\$60bn fund](#), and [sixteen months on neither has a constitution, capitalisation, manager or first disbursement](#).

Capacity

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Digital ambassador programme	A US\$4.5m phase from 2022 to 2026 active with the information society authority	The phase concluded with 1,567,034 citizens trained, 1,000 ambassadors and 30 supervisors deployed and five service access points established	CLOSED, FINANCING PHASE
National AI literacy teacher programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	More than 5,000 teachers across every district trained in the first phase, as asserted	Baseline not held

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Coding academy	Operating on about US\$7.9m including a government counterpart, with 118 students across two intakes in September 2021	The same financing, now the exclusive admission route into the new computing institute's first two intakes	ADVANCED, BECOMES SOLE FEEDER
Inclusive digital transformation centre	US\$275.7m across an endowment and a centre, from 2022 to 2035, targeting 10,000 learners	Unchanged; no progress figure against the target at any date	NO CHANGE
Artificial-intelligence trust and safety training for officials	Baseline not held	Training delivered to senior officials, financial and telecommunications actors and the judiciary, funded by Canada through the United Nations development programme; participant numbers, curriculum and cost are not stated	BASELINE NOT HELD

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Continental research and education partnership	BASELINE NOT HELD	An advanced technology innovation centre at a public university, recorded active	Baseline not held

Inclusion

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Accounts per mobile money agent	About 42 accounts per agent a year earlier, implied by the stated growth rates	About 44 accounts per agent, on 8,558,024 accounts against 195,739 agent lines	ADVANCED, AGENT NETWORK LAGGING
Formal financial access	48% of adults in 2008	96% of adults with formal financial access in 2024, with 68.5% using a mobile wallet but only about 5% holding a bank account	ADVANCED

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Smart-device affordability fund	A design stage with the development bank as financial intermediary, phased pilots and social-category subsidy targeting	The same design stage, with no market assessment, pilot or disbursement figure held	NO CHANGE
Universal access or service fund	In force under a presidential order of 12 May 2023, with each licensee's annual contribution capped at 2.5% of the turnover of each category of regulated service	The same; the operative rate is a regulatory-board decision not held, and the most recent accounts held remain 2020/21, when Frw 3,828,837,334 was spent against a Frw 6,372,536,516 budget	NO CHANGE
Urban and rural internet use gap	Urban usage 57%, rural 19%	Urban usage 57%, rural 19%, unchanged because unrepeatd	NO CHANGE

At the window's opening the inclusion layer was infrastructure without a rail. Twelve months on, the rail is mandatory at a flat fee, 4.4 million people are biometrically enrolled including refugees and stateless persons, the third-generation network has a hard retirement date, and an institute of computing opens in September — but every one of those is a switch-on rather than a measured outcome.

A digital-ambassador programme also closed out this window, concluding its financing phase in May 2026 [having trained 1,567,034 citizens](#), with no successor financing held.

The clearest single regression is the second mobile-money operator — market share and agent count both down over exactly the period interoperability was supposed to help. The [urban and rural internet-use gap, 57% against 19%](#), is unchanged because the survey has not been repeated.

Data

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Statistics programme appropriation	RWF 1,654,449,677 domestic under one ministry for 2025/26	RWF 1,419,073,405 domestic under another ministry for 2026/27, against RWF 9,386,979,010 external	REGRESSED

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National satellite data programme (Planet)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Government agencies, public universities, selected startups and development partners given access to near-daily imagery for agriculture and food-security monitoring, forest health, urban planning and disaster response, managed by the Rwanda Space Agency; no cost, term or data-licence arrangement published	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Geopolitics

India activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Indian-origin technology investment	The capital listed among future edge data-centre sites within a continental plan, with no site, capacity, date or investment figure	Unchanged; nothing further held as at 2026-08-05	NO CHANGE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Data-centre water policy	the only country-specific energy source the base holds; probed 2026-08-05, no instrument on data-centre water use exists; the cloud directives cover cooling and humidity but not water	2026-08-05
Sovereign AI compute	named-analyst opinion whose author sells sovereign AI infrastructure; probed 2026-08-05, no government document establishes national AI compute capacity; the nearest instrument is a continental pre-qualification exercise, not a Rwandan programme	2026-08-05
Space programme appropriation	the only satellite-data source the base holds for this country; probed 2026-08-05, the 2023/24 development budget annex carries the space agency by project and funding type	2026-08-05
National AI risk-assessment and harms-monitoring body	qualitative workshops, not a survey, and the report claims no representativeness; probed 2026-08-05, no such body is constituted; the 2023 AI policy only recommends a responsible AI office, which an external observatory recorded as not yet operational in February 2026, and the June 2026 AI agency's establishing law was not found	2026-08-05
Review framework for commercial AI partnerships	external commentary, attributed not adopted; probed 2026-08-05, no instrument requiring review or disclosure of commercial AI partnerships exists; the only material found is external commentary asserting the same	2026-08-05
National open-data portal or policy	probed 2026-08-05, the live data sharing platform and the 2017 data revolution policy located; the national data sharing policy expressly scopes open data out; acquisition attempted 2026-08-05 and failed, absence now stated dated on the place hub	2026-08-05
European adequacy decision	desk-review analysis, with the counts round estimates single-sourced to a secondary tracker; probed 2026-08-05, the Commission's own list of recognised third countries names no African state, establishing the negative as at 2026	2026-08-05
Sovereign AI compute or national model	a named analyst's dependency argument plus the absence of any contrary record; probed 2026-08-05, a June 2026 cabinet decision creating an AI agency is reported but no establishing law, gazette entry or compute procurement was found, and the only national-model candidate is a private company announcement	2026-08-05
Bilateral technology instrument with China	surveillance supply is asserted only at continent level with no national contract named; probed 2026-08-05, a signatory embassy's own account gives the December 2021 smart education loan framework agreement, whose text is unpublished; a 2017 vendor memorandum is likewise only described	2026-08-05

Two of the absences below carry more weight than the rest, and neither closed during the period: the consent and access-log layer that the privacy case for the identity programme rests on has no delivery evidence at all, and the government data-sharing platform has no go-live announcement with its target year two-thirds gone. They are the first briefs for the country-deep sweep.

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